HS4002: Lecture 10A

Online Surveys

Ma Xiangyu

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Online Surveys

Online Surveys

Online surveys, whether it be on phones, computers, through apps or websites, have become the dominant way of conducting surveys today.

Online Surveys

1. How do you recruit respondents and conduct the survey?
2. How do you design the survey?

Strengths

- Ability to deliver complex survey instruments while minimizing social desirability biases
- Flexibility and convenience for respondents.
- Allows surveys to reach otherwise hard-to-reach individuals
  $\rightarrow$ e.g. younger respondents, those in rural areas.
- Makes it easy to offer rewards for participation.

Weaknesses

- Concerns over representativeness
  - → There is no way of sampling the general population.
  - → Sampling frame is often constructed through non-probability approaches, whether it is through quota or convenience sampling.
  - → Remember coverage error?

Recruiting Respondents

On Sampling

Online surveys are a mode of surveys. They are compatible with different kinds of sampling methods.

Common Probability Sampling Methods

- Using email addresses from a target population.
- Online intercept surveys.
- Using offline methods to recruit probability-based panels
  - $\rightarrow$ e.g. Gallup, Pew's *American Trends*, NORC's. *AmeriSpeak*

Common Non-Probability Sampling Methods

1. Opt-in or access panels.
   → e.g. Qualtrics, Dynamo, Prolific.
2. Commercial survey marketplaces.
   → e.g. Lucid/Cint
3. Online work platforms.
   → e.g. Amazon M-Turk
4. Convenience sampling.

How Opt-In Panels Work

- Companies usually employ multiple ways of recruiting respondents (“recruitment channels”)
- Each recruitment channel has its own reward systems, and captures different types of respondents.
- The respondents are then “blended” from the different channels to create "blended panels."

How Opt-In Panels Work

Typical recruitment channels:

- (1) Loyalty panels
  - → They recruit through loyalty programs in travel, entertainment and media.
  - → Rewards are points.
  - → Tend to recruit more affluent individuals.

How Opt-In Panels Work

Typical recruitment channels:

- (2) Open recruitment
  - → They recruit across the web, using advertising, mobile apps, influencers, billboards and so on.
  - → Rewards tend to take the form of points to redeem for cash etc.

How Opt-In Panels Work

Typical recruitment channels:

- (3) Integrated channels
  - → People that come from particular social networks, communities (e.g. discord communities, podcast communities).
  - → Rewards tend to be in the form of points that can be redeemed for cash, prizes, and gift cards.

How Opt-In Panels Work

1. Potential respondents receive an email invitation, or are invited through a relevant app portal.
2. Company verifies their eligibility, and matches them to a suitable survey.
3. Respondents are offered one specific survey.
4. Respondents take the survey (there may be "screener questions")

How Good Are Opt-In Panels?

- It's largely uncertain.
  - $\rightarrow$ Survey companies will convince you that it's better than you think, but there are lots of skeptics still.
- We can do some limited comparison on the basis of observable sociodemographic variables.

How Good Are Opt-In Panels?

POPULATION VS. PANEL SAMPLES

	South Korea			Turkey			US		
	Population	Qualtrics	Dynata	Population	Qualtrics	Dynata	Population	Qualtrics	Dynata
Number	51.78	1.30mil	N/A	84.24mil	1.97mil	N/A	331.89mil	56.40mil	N/A
Female	.50	.51	.50	.51	.28	.44	.52	.62	.57
under 18 years old	.04	.10	N/A	.07	.10	N/A	.07	.06	N/A
18-24 years old	.09	.32	.08	.11	.44	.28	.09	.30	.11
25-34 years old	.13	.28	.29	.16	.26	.32	.14	.26	.20
35-44 years old	.15	.17	.32	.15	.11	.22	.13	.16	.23
45-54 years old	.17	.09	.21	.13	.04	.11	.12	.10	.14
55-64 years old	.16	.03	.08	.10	.02	.05	.13	.07	.14
65 years and over	.32	.01	.02	.08	.02	.01	.17	.04	.19
Income Bracket 1	.79	.43	.35	.56	.48	.50	.71	.30	.41
Income Bracket 2	.10	.26	.37	.25	.10	.19	.24	.26	.46
Income Bracket 3	.03	.12	.21	.09	.15	.20	.04	.05	.11
Income Bracket 4	.08	.06	.08	.10	.06	.11	.01	N/A	.02
Prefer not to answer	N/A	.14	N/A	N/A	.20	N/A	N/A	.14	N/A
Secondary Education or below	.49*	.30	.17	.69	.41	.33	.37	.40	.08
Cert., Vocational Training	.14*	.13	.07	.15	.16	.16	.25	.34	.12
Bachelor's Degree	.32	.42	.64	.13	.25	.36	.24	.16	.74
Postgraduate Degree or above	.04	.08	.12	.02	.12	.15	.14	.09	.06
Prefer not to answer	N/A	.08	N/A	N/A	.06	N/A	N/A	.03	N/A
Urban	.92	.93	N/A	.64	.92	N/A	.73	.74	N/A

Note: The *Under 18 years old* variable includes ages 13-17 for South Korea, Turkey, and the US. For the US, population education statistics are for ages ages 25 and older. The income brackets for South Korea are as follows: Bracket 1: < 40mil KRW; Bracket 2: 40-70mil KRW; Bracket 3: 70-100mil KRW; Bracket 4: > 100mil KRW. For Turkey, they are: Bracket 1: < 50k TRY; Bracket 2: 50-100k TRY; Bracket 3: 100-200k TRY; Bracket 4: > 200k TRY. For the US, they are: Bracket 1: < 50k USD; Bracket 2: 50-150k USD; Bracket 3: 150-500k USD; Bracket 4: > 500k USD.

* The *Secondary Education or below* variable for South Korea also includes vocational training

Designing Online Surveys

1. Invitations, Incentives, and Reminders

- You have to invite people, incentivize people to participate, and remind them to complete their surveys.
- This is obviously non-trivial.
- Often, can be delegated to commercial survey companies (with a cost of course).

2. Survey Landing Page

- This is the first page your respondents see.
  - → Reduce the perceived costs by specifying the survey length.
  - → Use simple language and a friendly visual design.
  - → Think about how much of your identity to reveal (can provide legitimacy, but also bias response).
  - → Specify some possible benefit.
  - → Warn against poor response quality.

3. Screener Questions

- You may screen for particular types of respondents.
- You may also want to screen for careless respondents.
  - $\rightarrow$ e.g. with logical questions, or honesty checks.

4. Test for Technical Problems

- Test surveys on different platforms and devices.
- Test complex survey designs.

Designing Online Surveys with Qualtrics

Qualtrics@NTU

- Qualtrics is the survey platform NTU provides. You write the questionnaire, publish a link, and download the responses.
- Qualtrics@NTU is run by the Centre of IT Services (CITS).
- The student steps are on the library FAQ: `https://libfaq.ntu.edu.sg/faq/275968`

Getting an account

1. Sign in once with your NTU account at `https://ntusingapore.qualtrics.com`
2. Watch the onboarding video. It covers the PDPA and NTU's Data Governance Policy (the FAQ calls this DGP).
3. Pass the activation assessment, at 85% or above.
4. Wait. Verification and activation can take up to five working days.

Why use Qualtrics?

- NTU provides the account.
- Qualtrics makes it easy to implement complex design logics: can show or hide a single question, skip to the end, and randomize the order of items.

Thanks for listening :)